

IDENTIFY AND SCHEDULE PLEASANT ACTIVITIES

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Identify, schedule, and participate in enjoyable activities.
2. Enjoy the pleasant feelings that social, leisure, and recreational activities can bring.
3. Report a lift in mood resulting from increased social and recreational activity.

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE MOST USEFUL

- Family Conflict
- Intimate Relationship Conflicts
- Type A Behavior

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The client's depression may interfere with his/her ability to recall pleasant activities and he/she may censor many of these activities, feeling he/she does not have the energy for them. Encourage him/her to brainstorm freely. If it is necessary, this assignment can be done within the counseling session rather than relying on the reduced motivation of the depressed client to fulfill the requirements of the assignment. Perhaps the brainstorming and scheduling need to be done within the session and the homework is that of implementing the activity and recording its impact. It is recommended that the client monitor his/her mood before, during, and after the event to focus him/her on the positive effect that the event has on mood. Review and reinforce the client's success in improving his/her mood using the satisfying activities.

[illegible][illegible][illegible]

2. Now select from your list of pleasant events seven that you believe are most likely for you to engage in. In the seven lines, list those activities and then to the right of the activity, write a few words that describe what was positive about the activity or why you found it pleasant or enjoyable.

Most Likely Activities

Why Pleasant?

1) _____	_____
2) _____	_____
3) _____	_____
4) _____	_____
5) _____	_____
6) _____	_____
7) _____	_____

3. On the following lines, schedule one pleasant activity per day to which you are committed. Include the time of the day and with whom you might share the activity.

Activity

When and With Whom

Day 1 _____	_____
Day 2 _____	_____
Day 3 _____	_____
Day 4 _____	_____
Day 5 _____	_____
Day 6 _____	_____
Day 7 _____	_____

4. On the following lines, record the activity engaged in and the degree of satisfaction on a scale of 1 (low) to 10 (high) that was felt during and after the engagement with the pleasant event. Also record the effect that the pleasant event had on your mood using a scale of 1 (no positive effect) to 10 (strong uplifting effect on mood).

Activity

Satisfaction

Effect on Mood

Day 1 _____	_____	_____
Day 2 _____	_____	_____
Day 3 _____	_____	_____
Day 4 _____	_____	_____
Day 5 _____	_____	_____
Day 6 _____	_____	_____
Day 7 _____	_____	_____